

Rep. Tom Emmer on Mornings with Fox Business

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TAYLOR:

Joining me now, House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer. Congressman, thank you for joining. We're less than two months away now from the midterms. What is the game plan for the GOP to hold the House?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, great to be with you. And the game plan is pretty simple. I mean, I love when people say the writing's on the wall in certain races, which races? I mean, we've got, first thing you gotta do, Taylor, you gotta keep what you have. We've got some true time-tested, battleground swing district incumbents, right? In Pennsylvania, in Iowa, in Arizona. I mean, these guys, they know what they're doing. They've been in these races before. The House does not set the message. The House is 435 pieces of geography. Each one has a unique demographic to that geography. It's not like a Senate race, which spans all the demographics in a state. It is a specific geographic location. In our case, we don't set the national message, but we do get impacted by it. That being said, we can fight through that. So you gotta first keep the people that you've got, and then look at the map. The map is they're defending over 20 of their members in seats that Donald Trump won. We're defending nine of ours.

TAYLOR:

So how do you manage the national message versus local issues? Like, I don't like the data center now in my backyard, or my grocery bill still feels too high. That seems, housing's unaffordable, and that's sort of that local issue. How do you balance those?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, it's interesting. First, it's funny. People, when they're asked, do not like Congress. But when they're asked about their member of Congress, they absolutely love their member of Congress. So first, you have to look at that. Second, with groceries, for instance, you gotta start talking about, we still have work to do. There's no question. But eggs are at pre-pandemic prices. Beef is at less than \$2 a pound for ground beef. You gotta start focusing on the fact that billions of dollars are being pumped back into this economy. You gotta look at that jobs report from a week ago where it was three times higher than anything they expected. And by the way, it was not for gig jobs, jobs for DoorDash, Uber. It was for high-paying, benefit-providing, high-tech jobs, manufacturing jobs. So then you gotta focus on, we lowered your taxes, we sealed the border. You gotta talk about the things you have done. I think we've got a lot to run on. All the Democrats have is something to run against. That's not the way to win elections.

TAYLOR:

But what do you say, though, to the critics who say the one big, beautiful bill was a last-year issue? And I'm looking and saying, what have you done for me this year?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Again, you've gotta talk about what it's doing to the economy right now. You go back and you talk about the fact that it was double-digit inflation under Joe Biden. It was, the economy was in the ditch. What Republicans and Donald Trump have done over the last several months is start to bring the economy back. Is it all the way back? No, but by the way, you have to look at people's behavior. Spending is up 6% from last year to this year. Wages, real wages are up. This is where you gotta focus because people's perception is not quite what the reality is. The reality is things are coming back very quickly.

TAYLOR:

Yeah, I mean, we're in a construction boom. We're in a manufacturing boom. Those ISM manufacturing numbers are up for eight straight months in a row in August. You're looking at an Atlanta Fed GDP at 4.4%. That'll update today in about 90 minutes. It's been north of 4%, I think, for most of the whole time that it's been out. How do you translate, though, that into people say they don't feel good even though they are spending? And then, frankly, as you mentioned, the numbers look good.

REP. TOM EMMER:

And that's exactly right. You need to focus on the things that are good. You gotta talk to your constituents. You gotta remind them. By the way, I think a lot of the political elitists here in Washington, D.C., I think a lot of the left-wing media, they believe what they wanna believe. Americans are much smarter than these people give them credit for. They understand what the election's about. I think we just have to have our candidates out there and our incumbents talking about the good things that are actually happening in the economy and how we're gonna work on this as we go forward to make it even better. And I feel good about where we're at for November 3rd.

TAYLOR:

I wanna pivot to crypto this morning. We're watching it at the Senate, of course, yesterday, failing to advance the Clarity Act. It was a 49-50 vote, falling short of the 60 votes needed. All Democrats and four Republicans opposed. What does this mean for the future of crypto regulation?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, unfortunately, the Senate's been having this problem now for a year. We sent the Clarity Act. First, let's back up. The Genius Act was passed last year and signed into law. This is dollar-backed stablecoin legislation. That was the first thing that needed to be done. But the problem is you just have the Genius Act, the dollar-backed stablecoins, without the market structure bill, which market structure, for people who are watching, this would be a legislation that would tell you if it's cash, if it's a commodity, or if it's a security, so you know who you're dealing with. With the Genius Act, without the Clarity Act, it's like having a cell phone without cell towers, right? It's very disappointing that they did not get this passed yesterday or get the process started. But I don't think it spells doom. I think it just delays it until after the midterms. I think that's what you're dealing with. You will see the Clarity Act again in the Senate after the midterms. I think you'll get it done before the end of the year.

TAYLOR:

We'll be waiting, and if it happens, we hope to hear from you. Thank you for joining us, Congressman Tom Emmer.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Absolutely, thanks.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

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